

Sara Montese

Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya, Barcelona, ES | sara.montese@upc.edu | [Scholar](#) | [Linkedin](#)

EDUCATION

- **Ph.D. in Artificial Intelligence** 01/2025 - present
Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya Barcelona, ES
Thesis topic: Agent Explainability with focus on teleology, goal prioritisation and policy improvement
Supervisors: Ulises Cortés, Sergio Alvarez-Napagao
- **M.Sc. of Data Science and Engineering** 09/2022 - 10/2024
Politecnico di Torino Turin, IT
Thesis: "Policy Graphs and Theory of Mind for Explainable Autonomous Driving". *Mark:* 110/110.
Supervisors: Carlo Masone, Ulises Cortés, Àtia Cortés, Victor Gimenez-Abalos
Exchange: 1-year Erasmus+ at Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya
- **B.Sc. of Computer Science and Automation Engineering** 09/2019 - 07/2022
Università Politecnica delle Marche Ancona, IT
Thesis: "Hybrid Random Forests: a new approach to image classification". *Mark:* 110/110 *cum laude* and honourable mention.
Supervisors: Domenico Ursino
Exchange: 4-month Erasmus+ at ESIEA Graduate School of Engineering (Paris, FR)

RESEARCH / ACADEMIC EXPERIENCE

- **Teaching Assistant** 09/2025 - present
Universitat Politècnica de Catalunya Barcelona, ES
Courses: Responsible Artificial Intelligence ([RAI](#)), Intelligent System Project ([ISP](#)), Artificial Intelligence ([AI](#))
- **Research Engineer** 12/2024 - present
Barcelona Supercomputing Center (BSC) Barcelona, ES
 - Researching on agent explainability and the intersection with LLMs and LLM-agents
 - Participating to AIXPERT, a HORIZON project that includes theoretical research and practical work on explainable-by-design agentic systems
 - Contributing to [pgeon](#), a library for explaining opaque agents using Intentional Policy Graphs
- **Junior Research Engineer** 05/2024 - 12/2024
Barcelona Supercomputing Center (BSC) Barcelona, ES
 - Researched on explainability for self-driving cars behaviour as part of the European project AI4CCAM
 - Developed an open-source [implementation](#) for explaining the behaviour of vehicles from traffic data

PUBLICATIONS

- **Explaining Agent Intentions**
International Conference on Autonomous Agents and Multiagent Systems, AAMAS 2026 (Doctoral Consortium))
[S. Montese](#)
- **The Illusion of Explainability with LLMs and LLM-Agents**
International Workshop on Explainable, Trustworthy, and Responsible AI and Multi-Agent Systems, EXTRAAMAS 2026 (Accepted for publication)
[S. Montese](#), [S. Alvarez-Napagao](#), [V. Gimenez-Abalos](#), [U. Cortés](#)
- **Intentional Policy Graphs: a pipeline for explaining agent behaviour through intentions**
Patterns, 2026
[V. Gimenez-Abalos](#), [S. Alvarez-Napagao](#), [A. Tormos](#), [S. Montese](#), [U. Cortés](#), [J. Vázquez-Salceda](#)
- **Explaining Autonomous Vehicles with Intention-Aware Policy Graphs**
International Workshop on Explainable, Trustworthy, and Responsible AI and Multi-Agent Systems, EXTRAAMAS 2025
[S. Montese](#), [V. Gimenez-Abalos](#), [A. Cortés](#), [U. Cortés](#), [S. Alvarez-Napagao](#)
- **Intention-aware Policy Graphs for Explainable Autonomous Driving**
Workshop of 36th IEEE Intelligent Vehicles Symposium, IEEE IV 2025
[S. Montese](#), [V. Gimenez-Abalos](#), [A. Cortés](#), [U. Cortés](#)

GRANTS AND AWARDS

- **AI4Science Fellowship**

12/2024 - present

BSC & Ministerio para la Transformación Digital y de la Función Pública

- **START STEM Scholarship for academic excellence**

2023 edition

Unione Industriali Torino

SERVICE

- Organizer and presenter of AAMAS 2026 [tutorial](#) on *Explainable Agency*
- Academic Reviewing: IEEE IV, AAMAS, EXTRAAMAS, NCSU Ethics & AV Workshop
- ACIA member (2025-present): Associació Catalana d'Intel·ligència Artificial
- WiCS member (2025-present): Women in Computer Sciences at BSC